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TITLE

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Niklas Loeser

Abstract

- English -

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Abstract

- German -

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1 Introduction

Code completion provides code suggestions to developers extending their incomplete code. The suggestions used multimodal data sources to combine a variety of information.

It is one of the most used productivity tools in Integrated Development Environments (IDEs). Every major IDE from VSCode, Jetbrains IDEs, Eclipse, Neovim and Emacs with plugins support code completion. It reduces the mental burden of remembering method names, properties, their types and associated information, such as documentation and if the item is deprecated. In addition it saves time by reducing written boilerplate code by suggesting code snippets. Using the code completion saves time spent searching for corresponding documentation outside of the IDEs.

As Amann et al.[1] found, code completion is the most frequently used tool inside IDEs with a frequency of 19.7%. Moreover, developers spend 22.4% of their time inside IDEs navigating code, in contrast to 28.5% editing and executing the code. They hypothesize that a significant amount of time navigating code is spent due to a lack of understanding of the code. Moreover, 39.8% of the total time is spent outside the IDE, which likely includes time spent searching for documentation.

Good code completion is a crucial tool for developers, reducing time spent in total and reducing the time spent outside the IDE, further increasing the focus of the developer.

1.1 Motivation

Neural code completion tools, such as GitHub Copilot, have seen a massive adoption in the software development community.

Such tools promise to complement typical code completion tools by providing context-aware code completions spanning multiple lines. These multi-line completions reduce the need to write boilerplate code further, thus improving the productivity.

While typical code completion tools use static analysis to provide completions, neural code completions tools use causal language models trained on code to predict the next tokens. As Ziegler et al. [2] have shown, the completions provided by Copilot serve as a template to tinker with.

Even if the completions provide a starting point, this work argues that current neural code completions do not use enough context to be accurate and are insufficient if used without the correct documentation.

Causal Language Modelss (CLMs) are released together with a “cutoff date”, which is the date until which the training data has been collected. These models are incapable of predicting code completions which rely on information released after the cutoff date. Even worse, the training data may contain information on a mixture of several old versions of the same item.

Widely used code packages are updated frequently, in which code is added, removed, or changed. Often the code is not removed directly, but marked as deprecated. It is still available, but should not be used anymore.

It is no surprise, that given a coding environment with specific versions of packages, the completions are often incapable of using correct code items. When using cutting-edge packages, the suggestions may not know anything, contain now renamed function parameters or use long deprecated methods. For legacy projects the reverse is true, as the neural code completion may suggest items from newer versions, which are not available in the project. As such, developers are forced to use the suggestions as a rough template, which they have to adjust to the correct documentation. Hence, developers use classical IDE tooling or consult documentation directly to check single suggested items.

Methods such as retraining the model with correct package information ad-hoc are not feasible, as they are slow and require a lot of computational resources. Other dynamic

methods providing the model with up-to-date information are not flexible enough and do not provide enough context to be accurate yet. Additionally, some current methods are too slow to be used in a real-time coding environment.

1.2 Goals

This thesis aims to combine up-to-date information through static analysis with the prediction capabilities of CLMs. The combination shall provide the neural code completion with the contextual information needed, to suggest code fitting the local code environment.

In addition, the time impact of the proposed approach shall be kept low, to ensure a responsive system.

In detail, the thesis will focus on combining static analysis through the use of language servers with the Transformers library, which offers a high level of control over the code generation.

The following research questions guide the thesis toward its goal:

Identifier	Keyword	Description
RQ1	Information source selection	Which sources provide CLMs with the necessary information to suggest fitting code?
RQ2	Context processing	How to filter sourced information to provide the most relevant information to CLMs?
RQ3	Context integration	How to integrate the contextual information into the neural code completion?
RQ4	Robustness	How to ensure the robustness of the approach?
RQ5	Generalizability	How to generalize the approach to work with different programming languages?
RQ6	Performance	How to reduce the performance impact of the approach?

Table 1: Research questions guiding the thesis.

1.3 Contributions

The main contributions of the thesis are:

1. Performant, robust and generalizable neural code completion using up-to-date package information.
2. A novel interrupt-based meta-strategy for injecting context into the model.
3. A dataset for evaluation functional and approach correctness.

The main contribution integrates information from the currently used packages and local repository into the code completion. The information is retrieved through the code completion and signature help functionality, provided by typical language servers, which generalize this work over different programming languages. The information includes deprecation information, preventing the model from completing old methods and guiding it towards replacements, using the provided documentation. Performance wise, the framework only incurs a small performance penalty over the usual predicted code completion.

The second contribution is a novel interrupt-based meta-strategy, which may be used outside of code completion. It enables monitoring the prediction similar to Agrawal et al. [3], but then injects retrieved information at critical timepoints into the context "during" the generation. It is used to inject the retrieved information into the model, nudging it towards the correct completion.

Lastly, the dataset evaluates, if the completed code is functionally correct and uses the correct approach. The evaluation checks, if e.g. a deprecated method was used and then fails the completed code. The dataset includes hand-picked code pieces of rapidly changing packages, legacy packages or new and unused packages. Each item includes the Python version and pinned dependencies, to create a reproducable code environment. To secure the evaluation, the evaluation pipeline uses Docker containers. In addition, the evaluation generates a report and draws diagrams.

2 Background & Related Work

This chapter provides important background information and related work, necessary to understand the main contributions of this thesis. Firstly, CLMs are introduced in Section 2.1. Thereafter, Section 2.2 discusses commonly used text generation strategies.

The section Section 2.3 showcases strategies to modify the text generation of a fixed pretrained CLM. Section 2.5 displays important components of the popular Hugging Face libary, which enables CLM workflows using all of the techniques introduced in the sections before.

Thereafter, Section 2.6 highlights important aspects of code generation. Continuing, Section 2.7 introduces the functionality of the Language Server Protocol (LSP). At last, Section 2.8 introduces previous work.

2.1 Causal Language Models

This section will first introduce the concept of a Language Models (LMs), then move from neural language models, to CLMs. Important text generation strategies for CLM are discussed in depth in the next section.

Language Models

Generally, LMs are probabilistic models of natural language[4]. They predict the next upcoming words based on already seen words[4]:

Previous text	*"The quick brown fox jumps over the lazy _"*
Prediction	*"dog"*

Example 1: Language model predicting the last word of the famous English pangram.

Development on LMs has led to powerful models. These now find widespread use in various applications, such as ChatGPT[5].

Neural Language Models

Neural language models are a type of LM. Their name stems from the McCulloch-Pitts neuron, which is a simplified view of a biological neuron as a computational unit[6], [4].

In contrast, a modern neural language model is a network of small computing units. Each of the units is a function that takes a sequence of values and returns a singular output value[4]:

$$f_{\text{unit}} : \mathbb{R}^n \to \mathbb{R} \tag{1}$$

Combining many units into a network allows the computation of a complex function f_{network}. The behavior of f_{network} can be changed by modifying the parameters inside of the network. By applying changes according to feedback, complex functions can be learned.

One very popular architecture for neural language models is the Transformers architecture.

As can be seen in Equation 1, the network is unable to process sequences of natural language directly. The text must first be encoded into numbers, the model can work with. After processing the encoded text, the result can be decoded into natural language once again.

Each neural language model encodes natural language into increasing numbers called tokens using a vocabulary V. The vocabulary is usually fixed, but can be changed as will be shown in the thesis. Each token represents a piece of natural language, such as a part of a word, or even parts of a sentence. The models initially map natural language

to tokens for processing. After processing the tokens these are decoded back into natural language.

Vocabulary	*{"The", "quick", "brown", "fox", "jumps", "over", "the", "lazy", "dog", "_", ".", "<BOS>", "<EOS>"}*
Text	*"The quick brown fox jumps"*
Tokens ids	*{11, 0, 9, 1, 9, 2, 9, 3, 4}*
Tokens	*{"<BOS>", "The", "_", "quick", "_", "brown", "_", "fox", "_", "jumps"}*

Example 2: Natural language encoded into tokens.

Example 2 showcases the tokenization for the start of the famous English pangram. The tokens values correspond to the index in the given vocabulary. The given vocabulary only provides tokens for full words and does not provide tokens for sub-word fragments. Not only does the vocabulary contain tokens for natural language, but also special tokens. These special tokens encode further semantic information for the CLM. Common special tokens are the Begin of Sequence (BOS), End of Sequence (EOS) and Padding (PAD) tokens:

BOS Marks the beginning of a natural text. Used to delimit several unrelated texts.

EOS Marks the end of a natural text. Used in combination with BOS. The text generation is stopped, when the model predicts the EOS token as the next token.

PAD Used to pad sequences from either side to a fixed length. This is necessary for the model to process several sequences of varying lengths at once.

Definition

Causal language models in turn are a type of neural language model. They rely on the assumption that the probability of a word occuring in a document depends only on the words occuring before it.

This property is called autoregressivity and highly favourable towards text generation, as it enables the continuation of any text. Given a text i_0 as input, the causal language model can predict the next word, as all previous words i_0 are known. After predicting the next word, the word is appended to the input to form the new input i_1. This process is repeated until the model predicts the end of the document using the special EOS token after n steps. i_n then forms the output and the whole generated text.

When applied to text completion or code completion, a program need only return the output i_n without the prefix i_0.

For the purposes of this thesis, a CLM can be defined using the following components:

- Raw next token prediction function f_{rntpf}
- Text generation strategy
- Autoregressive property

The raw next token prediction function is a mathematical function that takes a sequence of tokens and returns the prediction for the next tokens:

$$\begin{aligned} f_{\text{rntpf}}(x) &= u \\ f_{\text{rntpf}} &: \mathbb{N}^n \to \mathbb{R}^{|V|} \end{aligned} \tag{2}$$

The output u has the shape of the vocabulary, where each value u_i represents the logistical probability of token i being the next token. These values are called logits.

In an additional step, the logistical probabilities are normalized into values in the range of $(0, 1)$ to form a probability distribution.

The intermediary step of forming logits provides the benefit, that individual logits can be changed individually without disrupting the probability distribution. This property is essential for the main contributions in this thesis.

2.2 Text Generation Strategies

To generate a full sequence of tokens and thus a document, the model must choose the next probable token in the document using a text generation strategy TGS. After choosing the next token $\hat{w}$, where $1 \leq \hat{w} \leq |\text{vocab}|$, it is appended to the old input x to form x':

$$x' = x^\frown\langle\hat{w}\rangle = (x_1, x_2, ..., x_n, \hat{w}) \tag{3}$$

. Depending on the text generation strategy, the models generate different documents of varying quality. Each text generation strategy has different advantages and drawbacks. The next sections will introduce a few core sampling strategies and highlight the main advantages and drawbacks.

Greedy Decoding

Greedy decoding is the simplest of sampling strategies. The strategy always chooses the token with highest probability. This always yields the current best next token, but not necessarily the best token overall.

Its main advantage is the simplicity. The strategy does not require additional state. Only the current probabilities are needed. This also leads to low hardware requirements, compared to other strategies.

As the current best next token is not often the best token overall, the strategy does not produce the highest quality documents.

$$\hat{w} = \text{argmax}_{w \in V} P(w \mid w_{<n}) \tag{4}$$

Beam Search

Greedy decoding suffers from the problem of always choosing the current most probable token, even if it is not the best token overall. Beam search improves upon this by modeling the decoding process as a search tree. Instead of choosing only a single token, the strategy keeps k possible token choices. These k possible token choices are called hypothesis. At each time step the beam search uses the current k hypothesis to independently continue the generation to create $k * V$ possible token combinations. The strategy then keeps the top-k combinations as new hypothesis.

By modeling the decoding process as a search tree, beam search can choose tokens that are better overall. This leads to a higher quality generation.

But as beam search keeps k hypothesis and decodes $k * V$ possible token combinations, the strategy requires more memory and processing power.

Top-k

Top-k is a generalization of greedy decoding and a sampling strategy. Sampling strategies randomly choose the next token from the probability distribution. Top-k chooses the next token from the top k most probable next tokens. Hence, the model chooses a wider variety of tokens, leading to richer outputs.

As top-k is a generalization of greedy decoding, it has the advantage of being more powerful.

The main drawback is the loss of determinism. Lacking determinism may complicate interpretability methods.

Top-p

Top-k always chooses from the top k most probable tokens, even if most tokens are very unlikely and only few of the k tokens are probable. Top-p allows for more dynamic shapes of probability distributions, by only sampling from the top p percent of tokens.

Temperature sampling

Temperature sampling takes a different approach to top-p. It does not adapt to the shape of the probability distribution, but reshapes it. It divides the raw probability scores by a temperature τ:

$$y = \text{softmax}\left(\frac{u}{\tau}\right) \tag{5}$$

The softmax function normalizes the logits to the range $(0, 1)$, where the sum of all values equals 1. When dividing by $\tau < 1$ all values increase in total. After normalization this skews the probability distribution towards the most probable tokens. In contrast, when dividing by $\tau > 1$ the probability distribution is flattened. This leads to a more uniform distribution.

2.3 Controllable Generation

CLMs suffer from many problems, such as outdated knowledge, insufficient knowledge and insufficient capabilities. Most of these problems can be adressed by fine-tuning the model on further data, such as up-to-date information. The problem with fine-tuning is the need for a large amount of up-to-date data, which might not exist yet. In addition. fine-tuning is resource intensive and must be performed continously, to stay up-to-date.

This section will showcase different ways to control the generation of the model, without the need to perform fine-tuning. The text generation is complex and there are many different strategies and components, which may be controlled. Guided generation will focus in strategies to control the prediction of a single next token, while the chapter prompting strategies will focus on prompting techniques.

Guided Generation

The CLM generates a text, by iteratively choosing the next token ids. The decision on which token ids is the next token id, depends on two factors, as discussed in Section 2.1. It depends on the logits produced through the raw next token prediction function f_{rntpf} and a decoding strategy. Guided generation is a technique to modify the logits before the decoding strategy is applied. The logits are modified according to a set of domain specific rules. The rules not only have access to the current logits, but also to the previously generated text. Thes allows for complex rules.

Consider the following example:

A model is tasked with answering a “yes” or “no” question. The model should only respond with either of both words, without discussing any details or making small talk.
The rules for the guided generation are to set the logits of all tokens to $-\infty$, except when the tokens contribute to a “yes” or “no” answer.
Given the prompt “Is the sun shining?” and the previous tokens “Ye”, the guided generation will set all logits to $-\infty$, except for the token “s”. In the next step only the EOS token will be permitted. Thus, the model will respond with “Yes”.

Example 3: Enforcing "yes" or "no" answers

Guided generation has the benefit of allowing complex rules to be applied to the generation process, to allow a very tightly controlled generation.

The downside of guided generation is, that for complex scenarios, the rules may become very complex and hard to define. In these cases prompting strategies might be more appropriate.

[7]

Prompting strategies

Prompting strategies are a set of techniques to control the generation of the model externally. The model itself, or the model runtime itself is not modified. As such this technique is model agnostic. The general goal is to control the output through structured prompts. In addition, the model may be incorporated into external tooling to enable complex workflows.

The simplest form of control through prompting is to add instructions to the prompt. Models will follow the instructions, if the model was trained on instructions in a similar format. So called "instruction fine-tuned models" were fine-tuned especially on instructions, to improve instruction following capabilities. Non instruction fine-tuned models can still follow instructions, but then the instructions must be chosen carefully.

A useful instruction is to define the desired output format. For example, by specifying that the model should output the response in JavaScript Object Notation (JSON) format or Markdown format, the model will use the specified format. Especially formats such as Markdown and JSON are preferred, as they are common formats and thus the model performs especially well in these formats. Specifying the desired format increases the predictability of the response, which allows automated processing of the response. Specifying to respond in an unknown format does not work. Steering the model does not raise the capabilities of the model, but raises the efficiency with which its capabilities are used.

If the model does not have enough knowledge to respond to a prompt, the prompt itself can be structured to supply the needed information. Given the model has the ability to understand the provided information, it can then act on the information. A popular technique is **few-shot prompting**[8].

Few-shot prompting involves providing the model with several examples in the prompt. The goal is that the model understands the provided examples to learn the pattern and apply it to its response. The learning is undertaken "in context" and not persisted outside of the prompt itself[8]. The knowledge provided to the model is the format of the task and matching response.

Prompt:
Q: What is the capital of Germany?
A: Berlin
Q: What is the capital of France?
A: Paris
Q: What is the capital of Italy?

Response:
A: Rome

Example 4: Few-shot prompting

As can be seen in Example 4, the model prefixes the response with A: and does not provide additional information. The output format was not specified explicitly, but matches the format of the examples perfectly.

In contrast to providing knowledge about a desired response format, **context injection** adds important context into the prompt, which the model then uses to respond.

Prompt:
The capital of Germany was changed to Heidelberg.
What is the capital of Germany?

Response:
Heidelberg

Example 5: Context injection

Example 5 demonstrates how adding information controls the response of the model. This technique is very powerful, but comes with two strong restrictions:
1. Finding relevant context.
2. Limited prompt size.

The first restriction is that the injected context must first be found. This is a hard search problem, as the information must be retrieved **before** prompting, before the intent of the prompt is known yet. In Example 5 the task of the CLM is question answering. Even though the general task is known, the software has no way to known the specific domain, such as "country capitals" beforehand.

The second restriction is the limited prompt size. Models are only capable of focusing on a prompt of limited size. Thus, token space is precious and may not be wasted. Providing the model with an up-to-date version of Wikipedia for every prompt oversaturates the prompt size limit instantly. The injected context must be **targeted** and **relevant**. The more **targeted** the context is, the less tokens are used.

As finding relevant context is a hard problem, several steps are needed to search for the context. Searching for relevant context may even involve the output of another CLM. Strategies that involve the model in a multi-step process are called meta-strategies. These strategies will be further discussed in the next section.

Meta-Strategies

Meta-strategies incorporate a model into an algorithm according to a wider strategy. These strategies shift the focus to viewing the CLMs as a building block to be used as needed. Several models with different strenghts could be combined into a meta-strategy.

Generally, the main benefits are ease of use and flexibility. Any model can easily be integrated into the meta-strategy and stay interchangable. By combining several models into a multi-turn process, including external tooling, powerful behavior is possible.

In contrast, common drawbacks of meta-strategies are the added complexity towards the already complex text generation. In addition, calling models several times increases the runtime of the program, if used without care.

Meta-strategies are applied to e.g. remedy the model lack of up-to-date knowledge. A model may not have the necessary knowledge for a task, or the knowledge it has is outdated. In such cases the meta-strategy can supply up-to-date information and focus the model towards the problem.

Chain of Thought

Chain of Thought is one very central meta-strategy, as it significantly improves the reasoning capabilities of a model[9].

The key idea of chain of thought is to apply the divide and conquer strategy to the text generation process. Instead of the model trying to solve a complex reasoning problem in a single step, the meta-strategy divides the problem into several intermediate step. The model is then able to solve the simpler intermediate steps. Each intermediate step is a thought the model contributes to the final solution. The sequence of intermediate steps forms the "chain" of thoughts[9].

Additionally, the model will use thoughts of previous steps to reason about the next step.

Tree of Thought

[1] Tree of thoughts is a generalization of chain of thought. Chain of thought is only capable of performing linear decision-making[9]. Ultimately, performing complex reasoning is a search problem and thus, linear reasoning is insufficient. The tree of thoughts meta-strategy generalizes the thoughts into a tree structure. Each intermediate problem is then a node in this search tree. The root of the tree is the initial problem. The goal of this search problem then is to find an accepted end node - a finishing thought[10].

By structuring the thoughts into a tree, common tree search algorithms can be applied to the problem. Various algorithms such as a breadth-first search or depth-first search can be applied[10].

In general, the tree of thoughts meta-strategy is more powerful than the chain of thoughts. It is a very powerful and flexible strategy, which even allows following thoughts and then backtracking[10].

[10]

2.4 Torch

Torch is a widely used machine learning library in Python. It enables the creation and manipulation of tensors in different precisions. The Transformers provides high level abstractions which base on Pytorch. This section shortly introduces a few core concepts of Pytorch, which are used in the Transformers library. It will focus on version 2.2° of PyTorch.

PyTorch provides operations on tensors. A tensor is a multi-dimensional array of numerical values and the generalization of a matrix[11]. Each tensor typically only contains values of the same type, such as value from $\mathbb{R}$[11].

One of the applications for tensors is to represent multi-relational data[11]. In that case each dimension represents a single relation.

For CLM inference different types of tensors are used. For example, the token sequence during parallel text generation is a two-dimensional tensors of the following relations: (batch, token). The second dimension represents a single token sequence, while the first dimension enables parallel text generation for n token sequences.

Another example is the next token prediction tensor, which is a two-dimensional tensor of the following relations: (batch, vocabulary). The second dimension contains the probability distribution over the whole vocabulary, while the first dimension enables parallel text generation.

The second example only displays the tensor for a single next token prediction. By adding another dimension for the token relation, the whole probability distribution history could be represented.

After providing the motivation for tensors, the following list will introduce core terminology for use with tensors:

Order Number of dimensions of a tensor
Shape Number of elements in each dimension
Slice Two-dimensional subfield of a tensor. Obtained by fixing all but two indices.
Fiber One-dimensional subarray of a tensor. Obtained by fixing all but one index.
Matrix Two-dimensional tensor.
Vector One-dimensional tensor.
Scalar Zero-dimensional tensor.

[11]

[1] **Note:** Can be removed with Chain of thought

Fixing indices on a tensor will return a subfield or subarray, which in itself is a lower-order tensor. By fixing all indices a scalar is obtained. A slice and fiber are special terms for lower-order tensors obtained from fixing indices on a tensor.

As introduced earlies, tensors usually contain values of the same type. Each PyTorch tensor contains values of a single data type, in short: dtype. PyTorch supports many different numerical data types, of which the following are relevant:

Data Type	dtype
32-bit floating point	torch.float32
16-bit floating point 1	torch.float16
16-bit floating point 2	torch.bfloat16
64-bit integer (signed)	torch.int64
32-bit integer (signed)	torch.int32
Boolean	torch.bool

Table 2: Relevant PyTorch data types[12]

The data types can be used by specifying the dtype parameter when creating a tensor. The value is one of the variables listed in the dtype column in Table 2[13].

The difference between torch.float16 and torch.bfloat16 is the precision of the floating point number. Both formats use 16 bits to encode the floating point number. The difference lies in the number of bits used to encode the mantissa[12].

The torch.float16 is a half-precision floating point number, as defined in the IEEE 754 standard. It uses one sign bit, five exponent bits and 10 mantissa bits[14].

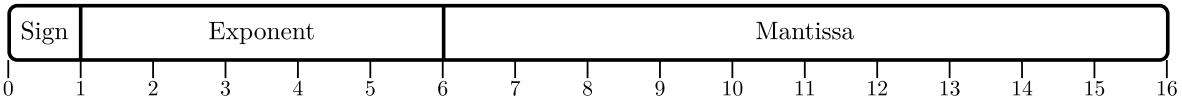


Figure 1: IEEE 754 half-precision floating point number: float16

In contast, the torch.bfloat16 keeps the full range of the full-precision floating point number of 8-bits, but has a reduced precision of 7 mantissa bits[15], [12].

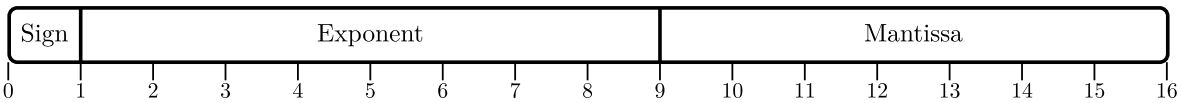


Figure 2: Brain Floating Point Format: bfloat16

The format was introduced by Google Brain and is used in their Tensor Processing Units (TPUs)[15], as the reduced mantissa precision reduces the size needed for physical hardware multipliers[15].

In addition to the precision, another aspect of a PyTorch tensor is the **physical location** it is allocated at, the device. The function torch.device creates a reference to such a physical location. Possible relevant device locations are cpu and cuda, where cpu allocates a tensor on the CPU memory, while cuda allocates the tensor on GPU memory[12]. Already creates tensor can be **moved to a different device** by calling the to method with the new device[16].

To **create a tensor**, the function torch.tensor is used. It takes data and optionally dtype and the device[13]. The order and shape of the tensor can be accessed through the dim and shape attributes[17], [18]. Indexing the tensor is done through the Python tensor[indice_list] notation, where untouched dimensions are marked through the : symbol, e.g.: tensor[3,:,1] [19]. Iterating the tensor will iterate over the first dimension.

2.5 Transformers Library

Transformers is the name of the popular Python machine learning library developed by HuggingFace. It provides broad support for many different machine learning domains, such as computer vision, audio processing, multimodal models and **natural language processing**[20]. For each domain, the library enables simple training and inference of state-of-the-art models. The thesis heavily relies on functionality provided by this library, as it provides in-depth features to implement the more advanced features. It provides support for all techniques introduced in Section 2.1 and Section 2.2[20].

As the library receives frequent updates, the thesis focuses on version 4.41.3°. In addition, the library is complex and enables many different use-cases through many abstraction layers. This section will focus on the CLM use-case, omit unneeded arguments and list parameters only available for CLM.

The structure of this section will mirror the structure of previous sections. It will start by introducing CLMs, then continue with tokenizers. Afterwards, the text generation functions are presented.

Using different text generation strategies with the Transformers library will follow. At last, implementing controllable generation will be shown.

Models

In transformers, every type of model architecture is represented by a model class. Each model defines the layers of the model and the operations between layers. Common model functionality is inherited through the base class PreTrainedModel[21].

Pretrained models provide the following functionality (not exhaustive)[21]:

- Loading pre-trained weights
- Resizing the token embeddings

Loading a pre-trained model for inference is done by calling the from_pretrained method on the model class:

```python
from_pretrained(
    pretrained_model_name_or_path,
    torch_dtype: str | torch.dtype = None,
    device_map: str | Dict[str, Union[int, str, torch.device]] = None,
    **kwargs
) -> PreTrainedModel
```

Listing 1: Loading a pre-trained model[22]

Calling Listing 1 returns a model instance with pre-trained weights, loaded onto one or several physical devices. The model is either loaded from a local directory, or from the HuggingFace model hub. Where the model is loaded from depends on the type of the pretrained_model_name_or_path parameter.

The HuggingFace model hub allows for easy access of pre-trained models, given the name of the model and the name of the publisher. The model name has the format publisher_name/model_name. Some[2] of the many available CLM for code generation are:

- codellama/CodeLlama-7b-Instruct-hf
- deepseek-ai/deepseek-coder-6.7b-instruct
- m-a-p/OpenCodeInterpreter-DS-6.7B
- ise-uiuc/Magicoder-S-DS-6.7B

In the case that a model name from the HuggingFace hub is provided, the model is downloaded and cached locally. If the model is already present, it is loaded from cache.

[2]More code generation models can be found in the Bigcode models leaderboard°

By default, the model will be loaded using the data type of the loaded weights. The torch_dtype parameters allows loading the weights in e.g. lower precision, to save memory during inference.

The device_map parameter controls on which devices the model is allocated. The parameter takes a PyTorch device as value. Passing auto computes the most optimized device map automatically.

Transformers provides an abstraction called AutoClasses. These abstraction solve the problem of finding the specific model, config and tokenizer classes to load and use a CLM. Instead, the correct classes can be guessed from the name of a model alone[22]. This simplifies code when trying different models for the same task, such as code generation:

```python
from transformers import AutoModel, LlamaForCausalLM
# The following line
model = LlamaForCausalLM.from_pretrained("codellama/CodeLlama-7b-Instruct-hf")
# Would be transformed into
model = AutoModel.from_pretrained("codellama/CodeLlama-7b-Instruct-hf")
```

Listing 2: Using AutoClasses to load a model[22]

The method resize_token_embeddings resizes the token embeddings of the model to a new size. The function is commonly used to account for new special tokens added to the tokenizer at runtime[21].

Tokenizers

Tokenizers provide the functionality to convert text to and from sequences of token ids. In addition, they store the vocabulary, including information on special tokens, such as the EOS token[23].

Loading a tokenizer is done through the AutoClasses abstraction, which will return an instance of a subclass of a PreTrainedTokenizer:

```python
from transformers import AutoTokenizer
tokenizer = AutoTokenizer.from_pretrained("codellama/CodeLlama-7b-Instruct-hf")
```

Listing 3: Loading a tokenizer[22]

The vocabulary can be accessed through the get_vocab method, which returns a dictionary mapping tokens to token ids[23]. Special tokens and token ids can be accessed directly through special attributes of the tokenizer:

Token attribute	Token ID attribute	Description
bos_token	bos_token_id	Beginning of sequence token and token id
eos_token	eos_token_id	End of sequence token and token id
pad_token	pad_token_id	Padding token and token id

Table 3: Special tokens and token id attributes[23]

Special tokens can be added at runtime by calling add_special_tokens with a dictionary containing the key additional_special_tokens with the list of new tokens[23].

The main functionality of a tokenizer is to convert text to token ids. This is done by calling the tokenizer directly, as it implements the special __call__ function[23]:

```python
__call__(
    text: Union[str, List[str]],
    add_special_tokens: bool = True,
    return_tensors: str = None,
    // ... omitted parameters
) -> BatchEncoding
```

Listing 4: Tokenizing text

The function in Listing 4 either tokenizes a single string, or a batch of strings. The output BatchEncoding has the field input_ids, which contains the sequence of token ids, or batch of token ids.

The output format of input_ids is controlled by the parameter return_tensors. By setting it to pt, the input_ids will be a PyTorch tensor.

By default, the tokenizer adds special tokens to the input text, such as the BOS and EOS tokens. This behavior can be controlled by the add_special_tokens parameter.

In contrast to tokenization, the PretrainedTokenizer class provides two different methods for detokenization. Both functions are similar in signature with the single difference that one method takes a single sequence of token ids, and the other method a batch of sequences[23].

The method decode decodes a single sequence and has the following signature:

```python
decode(
    token_ids: Union[torch.Tensor, List[int]],
    skip_special_tokens: bool = False,
    // ... omitted parameters
) -> str
```

Listing 5: Detokenizing a single sequence[23]

The method batch_decode has a similar signature, but decodes a whole batch of sequences. The parameter skip_special_tokens can be enabled to remove special tokens, which might be unwanted when e.g. displaying the returned text[23].

If single tokens are already present, these can be convert to token ids by calling the method convert_tokens_to_ids. The converse direction is possible by calling the method convert_ids_to_tokens. The method convert_ids_to_tokens also takes the parameter skip_special_tokens[23].

Config

Models show dynamic behavior, as they can be configured at runtime. This dynamic configuration enables the use of different generation strategies, by setting different model configuration values. Model configurations are classes inheriting from PretrainedConfig. The PretrainedConfig includes configuration values for the model architecture and for the mentioned dynamic behavior[24]. Instantiation a PretrainedConfig is possible through the abstraction AutoClasses, by using AutoConfig[22].

Often single configuration values can be passed into the model as single keyword arguments, without the need for a dedicated configuration object[25]. Different configuration values will be introduced as function arguments in the following sections.

Text Generation

After obtaining a model and a tokenizer, the text generation process can be performed by using one of the following three abstraction. The to be introduced abstraction build upon the previous abstraction.

The lowest level abstraction is the forward method of the model, which takes previous token ids and returns the logits for the next token id. The arguments to the function only control the provided output format and cache behavior[21].

The next abstraction is the generate method, which generates a whole sequence of tokens, until a stopping criteria is met, such as the EOS token. The functions is provided by the GenerationMixin class, which CLM inherit from using multiple-inheritance. The GenerationMixin implements the different text generation strategies, which can be controlled through the provided parameters[25]. The generate function has the following signature:

```python
generate(
    inputs: torch.Tensor,
    generation_config: GenerationConfig = None,
    logits_processor: LogitsProcessorList = None,
    stopping_criteria: StoppingCriteriaList = None,
    **kwargs
    // ... omitted parameters
) -> Union[ModelOutput, torch.LongTensor]
```

Listing 6: Generating a sequence of tokens[25]

Next to the provided input tensor inputs, the generation_config parameter contains configuration values to control the generation. Extra matching keyword arguments override keys in the generation config. Table 4 contains important configuration parameters:

Category	Parameter	Type	Description
Stopping Criteria	max_length	int	Maximum length of the generated sequence
	max_new_tokens	int	Maximum number of new tokens to generate. Overrides max_length
	max_time	float	Maximum time in seconds to generate
Generation Strategy	do_sample	bool	Whether to sample from the logits
	num_beams	int	Number of beams for beam search
Logits manipulation	temperature	float	Temperature for sampling
	top_k	int	Number of tokens to sample from
	top_p	float	Cumulative probability for sampling from
	repetition_penalty	float	Penalizes repeated tokens

Table 4: Generation configuration parameters[25]

The first parameters in Table 4 configure the first stopping criteria. The generation can be stopped when the sequence reaches a certain length, or when a certain time is reached.

The following diagram displays the different used generation strategies, depending on the provided parameters:

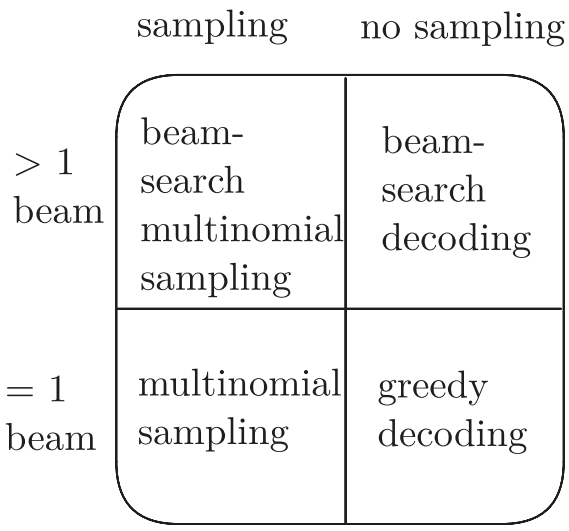


Figure 3: Generation strategies

The final parameters manipulate the logits before sampling. They enable Top-k, Top-p and Temperature sampling. The last parameter hinders models from endlessly repeating the same token, until a stopping criterium is reached.

Controllable Generation

The generation method provides parameters to overview and control the generation process. These parameters enable strategies as discussed in Section 2.3.

The first control mechanism are the stopping criteria. The stopping criteria define custom conditions that terminate the generation, when one of the conditions is met.

Transformers defines a few vital stopping criteria, like the maximum time or the maximum number of tokens to generate. These stopping criteria are enabled by passing certain keyword arguments into the generate method, as introduced in the section before[26], [25].

Custom stopping criteria are defined by subclassing the StoppingCriteria class and adding an instance of the new class to the stopping_criteria list in the generate method[26].

A subclass of StoppingCriteria only needs to implement the __call__ method:

```python
__call__(
    input_ids: torch.LongTensor,
    scores: torch.FloatTensor,
    **kwargs
) -> bool
```

Listing 7: Stopping criteria signature[26]

The method in Listing 7 returns whether the generation should be stopped, based on the previous token ids input_ids and the current scores. The method must support batching, as input_ids has the shape (batch_size, sequence_length) and scores the shape (batch_size, vocab_size)[26].

The second control mechanism are the logits processors. Logits processors manipulate the current logits before a decoding strategy chooses the next token id on the then manipulated logits.

Custom logits processors are defined by subclassing the LogitsProcessor class and adding an instance of the new class to the logits_processor list in the generate method. A subclass of LogitsProcessor only needs to implement the __call__ method:

```python
__call__(
    input_ids: torch.LongTensor,
    scores: torch.FloatTensor,
    **kwargs
) -> torch.FloatTensor
```

Listing 8: Logits processor signature[26]

The arguments in Listing 8 are identical to the arguments in Listing 7. The method must return the manipulated logits, which have the same shape as the input `scores`.

2.6 Code Completion

Special Properties

In contrast to normal generation, code completion can leverage many properties specific to code. The first main property is the syntax of the programming language of the to be completed code. The syntax of the full generated code must be valid according to the grammar of the programming language. The second main property is the semantics of the generated code. The generated code must be semantically correct. The code should execute without errors, such as using incorrect functions, methods, function parameters and types. Available documentation is the third property. Often code is documented to improve maintainability.

All three properties can be used as additionaly data sources for code completion.

Requirements

As the code completion is intended for use in IDEs, the following requirements are important:

- The generated code should be syntactically correct.
- The generated code should be semantically correct.
- To increase maintainability, the generated code should follow best practices.
- The developer might be working on a single file or a large project. For large projects, the generated code should be aware of the local code base.
- The developer could work on a project of **any** programming language.
- Knowledge about related code:

The CLM performing the task should take the following context into consideration when generating code: At the core, the CLM has the context of the local file that is edited. The next wider context is code in a local repository, when working on a larger project. At last, the model should use knowledge of installed packages.

Problems

Fulfilling all requirements using CLMs is hard. By solving the following problems, the requirements can be met:

1. Finding relevant context
2. Injecting context into generation process
3. Supporting most programming languages

The problems are discussed in the following sections.

Finding relevant context

Each CLM has ingrained knowledge about the data it was trained on. CLMs trained on code have limited knowledge about the language itself, the standard library and other dependencies. The problem with the inbuilt knowledge is that it is insufficient or outdated, especially for large projects with many dependencies. In addition, the knowledge only

reaches until the cut-off date of the training data and does not include changes afterwards. In contrast, working on legacy projects poses the same problem, as the knowledge the model was trained on is too new.

The conclusion is that a framework must find all needed information and supply it to the CLM - the "context". The following attributes are of importance:

1. **Scope**: The context should include information about the local file, repository and installed packages.
2. **Precision**: The context should not "drown" the model in information, but still provide all relevant information as compact as possible.
3. **Up-to-date**: The provided information on dependencies should be up-to-date with the version of the dependencies used in the local repository.

Injecting context into generation process

The next step in a framework is to inject the collected context into the generation process of a CLM. As seen in previous sections, many different approaches are possible and can be combined.

Supporting most programming languages

Finally, the framework should support most programming languages. This is crucial for the framework to be used in a wide range of projects. As each programming language has different syntax, semantic and package management, this problem is especially hard.

2.7 Language Server Protocol

Many modern editors and IDEs provide features such as:

- Autocompletion
- Signature help
- Go to the definition of a symbol
- Go to the uses of a symbol
- Provide diagnostics data on the current file
- Rename symbols

This list is not exhaustive, and the features between different editors may vary. These features are vital for any programmer, as the effort to create and maintain code is significantly reduced. Navigating large code bases and finding documentation on used code is highly beneficial.

These many features take a significant effort to implement for a **single** programming language and editor. Providing support for several programming languages massively increases the implementation effort. In addition, the created features must be maintained next to the editor itself. As more programming languages are designed and are adopted, the need for tooling for these programming languages arises. Editor maintainers must then integrate these features for the new programming language.

Providing support for an ever increasing amount of programming languages is hard, but supporting these features for an ever increasing amount of programming languages in every editor is impossible. Many diverse editors exist, such as Emacs[27], [28], VSCode[29], [30], Neovim (modern fork of Vim)[31], [32], Zed (the successor of Atom)[33], [34], Jetbrains IDEs[35], [36], Helix[37], [38] and many more.

Thus, a solution is needed to extract thes **common** features from the editors and provide them centrally, such that every editor need only implement an interface to integrate the common features. The Language Server Protocol is an effort to standardize a common feature set for programming language tooling for use in IDEs. The protocol was designed my Microsoft for use in its Visual Studio Code editor, but is now an open

standard. This thesis will focus on version 3.17 of the protocol. The protocol includes many different features, of which the following sections introduce a few important. The full specification may be accessed here[39].

Design

The protocol is based on a bidirectional client-server architecture. The client is a tool such as the IDE. The server, henceforth called the language server, is programming language specific tooling that provides a subset of the protocol. Both the client and server must not implement the full protocol. The protocol is capability based. Both parties define and communicate their capabilities, then find common capabilities and restrict their use to them. Each client can connect to multiple language servers, and each language server can serve multiple clients. As such a client could use a language server for the Rust programming language while the user is coding on a Rust project. As soon as the user switches projects to a web project, the editor could then connect to several language servers to provide support for HTML, CSS and JavaScript at once. In that scenario several simultaneous language servers are necessary, as CSS and JavaScript can be embedded into HTML. The communication between the client and server must be bidirectional, as the server must be able to notify the client about events occuring, such as new diagnostic information.

JSON-RPC

The base protocol relies on JavaScript Object Notation-Remote Procedure Call (JSON-RPC). The following section will give a short introduction on the protocol. The content part is specified using JSON-RPC. JSON-RPC is a light-weight and stateless protocol to encode Remote Procedure Calls (RPCs). The specification defines data structures and processing rules. As such, the protocol is transport-agnostic and can be used with any type of message passing framework. The data structures are encoded using the JSON data format.

The protocol is versioned. Currently the versions 1.0 and 2.0 are specified. The LSP uses version 2.0 of JSON-RPC. Henceforth, the sections will focus on version 2.0 of the protocol.

JSON-RPC defines three types of messages:

- Requests
- Responses
- Notifications

, though notifications could be considered a special case of requests. The following section will provide details on each type.

Messages will be defined using TypeScript interfaces, in accordance with the LSP specification. A general message has the following interface:

```typescript
interface Message {
  jsonrpc: string;
}
```

Listing 9: General message interface

To define the other message types, additional TypeScript types are introduced:

- integer: A signed 32-bit integer aliased to the TypeScript type number.
- uinteger: An unsigned 32-bit integer aliased to the TypeScript type number.
- LSPArray:

Request objects have the following JSON format, as defined by the following Typescript interface:

```typescript
interface RequestMessage extends Message {
  method: string;
  params?: any;
  id: string | number | null;
}
```

Listing 10: Request object format

The jsonrpc field contains the version used and must be set to 2.0. The method field contains the name of the remote procedure to be called. Any parameters needed to call the remote function should be passed in the optional field params. At last, the id field identifies the message and thus allows correlation between requests and responses. Using fractional numbers is discouraged, as the floating point accuracy issue contradicts the identification of the id.

Each request must be answered by a response. The response object has the following format:

```typescript
interface ResponseMessage extends Message {
  result?: any;
  error?: ResponseError;
  id: string | number | null;
}

interface ResponseError {
  code: number;
  message: string;
  data?: any;
}
```

Listing 11: Response object format

Similar to the request object, the jsonrpc field must be set to 2.0. Either the result or error field will be set, depending on the success of the request. To correlate requests and responses, the response will contain the id of the request in the field id.

Error responses contain the error code, a short descriptive message and optional additional data. The specification defines the following error codes and messages:

Code	Message	Meaning
−32700	Parse error	The server received invalid JSON
−32600	Invalid Request	The request is not a valid request object
−32601	Method not found	The method does not exist or is not available
−32602	Invalid params	Invalid method parameters
−32603	Internal error	An internal error occurred while processing the request
−32000	Server error	Reserved for implementation-defined server errors

Table 5: Error codes and messages

In addition, the protocol allows custom error codes.

The final type of message is the notification. Notifications are a special type of request, as they do not contain an id. Notifications do not require a response from the server:

```typescript
interface NotificationMessage extends Message {
  method: string;
  params?: any;
}
```

Listing 12: Notification object format

Base protocol

The base protocol defines the general format, in which messages are sent between the client and server. Each message contains a headers and a content part, separated by \r\n.

The headers part contains at least one header field, which are key-value pairs separated by a colon. Each header field is terminated by a \r\n. The following headers are currently supported:

- Content-Length: A mandatory header that specifies the length of the content part in bytes.
- Content-Type: The Multipurpose Internet Mail Extensions (MIME) type of the content part. The default is application/vscode-jsonrpc; charset=utf-8 and no other charset is currently supported.

The content part is a JSON object, as defined by the JSON-RPC specification. The LSP specification differs from the JSON-RPC in the use of certain types. It restricts the numeric type used for id and code from number to integer, to disallow floating point identifiers.

Basic JSON structures

Many RPCs share common structures needed to communicate about language features. The following section introduces a few necessary ones.

The first important structure is the Uniform Resource Identifier (URI), as defined by rfc3986[40]. URIs are passed as strings and are used to uniquely identify files the language server and client work with.

To identify a position inside such a file, the protocol defines the Position structure:

```typescript
interface Position {
    line: uinteger;
    character: uinteger;
}
```

Listing 13: Position structure

Line and character define the position in the file starting at 0.

The last structure is TextDocumentItem, which represents an editable text document:

```typescript
interface TextDocumentItem {
    uri: DocumentUri;
    languageId: string;
    version: integer;
    text: string;
}
```

Listing 14: TextDocumentItem structure

In addition to the unique identifier of the document, the uri, the structure contains the content of the document in the field text. The languageId field defines the language of the document. This is needed especially when the language server processes documents of different languages. Passing the languageId prevents re-interpreting the file extension. The possible language ids are defined in the specification and can be seen in Table 6 in full.

Lifecycle Messages

After defining the basic structures, this section introduces the first messages to control the lifecycle of the language server.

The first message the client sends the server, is the initialize message. No other communication will occur, until the server acknowledges the initialization with the response. The connection between client and server may only be initialized once. The initialize message has the following key fields:

```typescript
interface InitializeParams {
    rootUri?: DocumentUri;
    capabilities: ClientCapabilities;
    // ... more fields omitted
}
```

Listing 15: Initialize message parameters

The rootUri is an optional field that specifies the root path of the workspace, the client is working on. Setting the workspace e.g. enables finding virtual environments needed to scan the local code base. The next field capabilities is a complex structure of flags, which specify all capabilities the client has.

The server responds with the initialize result, which contains the server capabilities.

Afer receiving the response, the client must then acknowledge the response, by sending the initialized message. The server then has the option to e.g. register capabilities dynamically or run further initializations. Afterwards, the initialization process is finished.

After using the language server, the client can stop the server in a two step process. First, the client sends a shutdown message. The server then stops itself, but preserves its messaging capabilities to send a proper response. In the next step, the client sends the exit message, after which the server exits its process.

Document Synchronization

After introducing messages to establish and control the connection between server and client, this section focused on the next step, the document synchronization. The goal of these messages is to synchronize the server to the users actions. The server should provide capabilities for a file, while the user works on it.

The first message is the textDocument/didOpen notification. Sending this notification informs the server that the client opened the document. The message has the following structure:

```typescript
interface DidOpenTextDocumentParams {
    textDocument: TextDocumentItem;
}
```

Listing 16: DidOpenTextDocument message parameters

As soon as the file is closed, the client sends the textDocument/didClose notification. The message has the same structure as in Listing 16.

Other messages for synchronizing documents and notebooks exist and are omitted.

Language Features

This section displays messages to query language features. The LSP specification defines many different features, of which this section highlights the few relevant ones:

- Auto Completion
- Signature help
- Provide diagnostics data on the current file

The auto completion feature provides a list of completion items for a given position in a document. The completion items can be selected to provide more detailed information. On applying the selected completion item, the completion text is inserted into the document at the given position. The feature is split into the two messages textDocument/completion and completionItem/resolve.The first message queries the completion items for the given position in a text document. Each completion item only contains basic information. If further details are required, the second message completionItem/resolve asks the server to extend a single completion item with in depth details.

A completion item has the following structure:

```typescript
interface CompletionItem {
    label: string;
    insertText?: string;
    labelDetails?: CompletionItemLabelDetails;
    detail?: string;
    documentation?: string | MarkupContent;
    kind?: CompletionItemKind;
    tags?: CompletionItemTag[];
    deprecated?: boolean;
    preselect?: boolean;
    sortText?: string;
    filterText?: string;
    data?: any;
    // ... more fields omitted
}
```

Listing 17: CompletionItem structure

The first key property is label. The label is the main text to be inserted into the document and provides the full symbol. In case the document already contains a prefix of the label in the given location, the inserted text must not contain the prefix. In these cases the label property remains untouched, but insertText is set to the shortened text. insertText overrides the text to be inserted, but remains optional.

The labelDetails property contains additional information, such as the locator of the symbol to be inserted. The structure of the property can be found in Listing 18.

For accessibility, the completion item includes several human readable properties:

- detail provides a short description of the completion item.
- documentation provides a detailed description of the completion item. The description can be plain text or Markdown. The structure of the property can be found in Listing 20.

The next field kind specifies the type of the completion item. The type refers to the symbol kind, such as a "function", "field" or "string". The full list is defined in Listing 32.

Annotations can be found in the field tags. The only supported tag is Deprecated, as defined in Listing 19. It replaces the now deprecated field deprecated.

After receiving the completion items, the client can display the items in a list. The field preselect can mark a **single** completion item to be preselected in the list. Additionally, the client may filter and sort the items. In these cases it should use the fields filterText and sortText for theses tasks, instead of label.

Additional server specific data is stored in the field data. This information is needed by the server to resolve the completion item and should not be changed.

```typescript
interface CompletionItemLabelDetails {
    detail?: string;
    description?: string;
}
```

Listing 18: CompletionItemLabelDetails structure

```typescript
namespace CompletionItemTag {
    const Deprecated = 1;
}
type CompletionItemTag = 1;
```

Listing 19: CompletionItemTag enum

```typescript
interface MarkupContent {
    kind: MarkupKind;
    value: string;
}
```

Listing 20: MarkupContent structure

```typescript
namespace MarkupKind {
    const PlainText: 'plaintext' = 'plaintext',
    const Markdown: 'markdown' = 'markdown'
}
type MarkupKind = 'plaintext' | 'markdown';
```

Listing 21: MarkupKind enum

The Listing 20 structure includes markup content in the field value. The type of markup is defined in the field kind. Currently the two kinds **plain text** and **Markdown** are supported, as seen in Listing 21.

To request completions, the client then sends the textDocument/completion message. The request the following structure:

```typescript
interface CompletionParams {
    textDocument: TextDocumentIdentifier;
    position: Position;
    context?: CompletionContext;
    // ... more fields omitted
}
```

Listing 22: Completion message parameters

The request contains a position in the document textDocument. The optional context has further details on how the completion was triggered (triggerKind) and with which character it was triggered (triggerCharacter), as seen in Listing 23. Several trigger kinds are currently supported, such as invoked, triggered by a character, or re-triggered to expand an incomplete completion list (Listing 24).

```typescript
interface CompletionContext {
    triggerKind: CompletionTriggerKind;
    triggerCharacter?: string;
}
```

Listing 23: CompletionContext structure

```typescript
namespace CompletionTriggerKind {
    const Invoked: 1 = 1;
    const TriggerCharacter: 2 = 2;
    const TriggerForIncompleteCompletions: 3 = 3;
}
type CompletionTriggerKind = 1 | 2 | 3;
```

Listing 24: CompletionTriggerKind enum

The server then responds either with no result, directly with a list of completion items, or a completion list, as seen in Listing 25.

```typescript
interface CompletionList {
    isIncomplete: boolean;
    items: CompletionItem[];
    // ... more fields omitted
}
```

Listing 25: CompletionList structure

In addition to containing the completion items, the structure also may indicate that the list is incomplete and will be recomputed through the field isIncomplete.

Resolving a single completion item is done by sending the completionItem/resolve message. The message is the completion item to be resolved. The server then responds with the resolved completion item. The resolved completion item is a superset of the provided completion item.

The second feature is the signature help. The signature help provides information about the signature of the symbol at the specified position. A common use case is to display function and class parameters.

Sending the textDocument/signatureHelp request to the server returns the signature help. The request has a similar structure to Listing 22, as seen in Listing 26:

```typescript
interface SignatureHelpParams {
  textDocument: TextDocumentIdentifier;
  position: Position;
  context?: SignatureHelpContext;
  // ... more fields omitted
}
```

Listing 26: SignatureHelp message parameters

The context field contains additional information about the context in which the signature help was triggered.

The server responds with the signature help in the structure of Listing 27:

```typescript
interface SignatureHelp {
  signatures: SignatureInformation[];
  activeSignature?: uinteger;
  activeParameter?: uinteger;
}
```

Listing 27: SignatureHelp structure

The symbol could have several signatures, of which each is represented by a SignatureInformation structure. Each single SignatureInformation has a label, to be shown in the UI, as well as the documentation regarding the whole item. Single parameters can be retrieved through the parameters field. When typing a function call, the currently typed parameter becomes the active parameter in the SignatureInformation (activeParameter). The parameters each come with a label and documentation field. The label either is a string, or a range referring to the label of the outer signature.

The signature help structure is defined in Listing 28, while the single parameter information is provided in Listing 29.

```typescript
interface SignatureInformation {
  label: string;
  documentation?: string | MarkupContent;
  parameters?: ParameterInformation[];
  activeParameter?: uinteger;
}
```

Listing 28: SignatureInformation structure

```typescript
interface ParameterInformation {
  label: string | [uinteger, uinteger];
  documentation?: string | MarkupContent;
}
```

Listing 29: ParameterInformation structure

2.8 Related Work

Not many related work has focused on enhancing code completion specifically. The few works that enhance code completion fail to solve all three problems introduced in Section 2.6. Other work introduces general techniques to improve CLM generation for complex tasks, but does not apply such techniques on code completion.

The most promising previous work is "Monitor-Guided Decoding of Code LMs with Static Analysis of Repository Context"[3]. It uses static analysis of the generated code using LSP to constrain the completion of the dereference operator ".", names of instantiated classes, the number of arguments in a function call and enumeration options in a switch statement.

Relevant context is provided by the LSP. The information provided is precise, up-to-date and includes information on dependencies. The context is injected through watching and manipulating the logits using controlled generation, such as the `LogitsProcessor`. And finally the work is programming language independent through the use of LSP.

Generally, by combining static analysis through the LSP with controlled generation, most problems can be solved.

The work is currently partially limited to Java, as some features only support Java features and some features Java-style features, such as the `new` statement. Additionally, it does not disallow deprecated items and does not improve function arguments in constructors and other general functions.

Other work, such as "RepoCoder" [41] or "DocPrompting" [42], improve code completion on a repository level through Retrieval Augmented Generation (RAG) techniques, but fail in the scope and precision.

RepoCoder uses embeddings of the repository to retrieve relevant code context. This approach is not able to provide context on dependencies and does not propose an update mechanism for the local embeddings. Additionally, the precision is only as high as the quality of the embeddings.

DocCoder in contrast uses embeddings of documentation as context. The work does not propose specific documentation sources, as such the scope is not specified. As with RepoCoder, the precision is only as high as the quality of the embeddings. Lastly, the work does not propose an update mechanism for the embeddings.

3 Design

As was introduced in Section 2.6, the three main problems with code completion are finding **precise**, **globally scoped** and **up-to-date** context, injecting the context and a working framework for most programming languages. The few prior work presented in Section 2.8 has several weaknesses, such as only improving type-valid identifier dereferences, using deprecated dependencies, using imprecise context or having enough data sources.

This chapter first introduces a general design for a meta-strategy to robustly inject context into code completion in Section 3.1. Then a specific framework solving the aforementioned problems is detailed in Section 3.2. Finally, this work creates a dataset to benchmark the implementation of the design.

Each section will include the requirements, evaluation criteria and the components of each design. Furthermore, each requirement will be linked to research questions and thus the goals of the work.

3.1 Interrupt-based meta-strategy

As sketched in Section 1.3, the interrupt-based meta-strategy is a novel approach to integrate context into model generation. It is heavily focused on integration multiple information sources independently. The context shall be integrated seamlessly, without affecting the generation flow of the initial generation, except providing the additional information.

Requirements

The strategy shall be heavily focused on providing a seamless context integration, answering **RQ3**°.

Moreover, the strategy shall support multiple independent sources of information. This will go hand in hand with **RQ1**°.

The next requirement is for the strategy to be applicable to any type of use-case, such as neural code completion, following **RQ5**°.

Lastly, the strategy shall incur minimal overhead, as stated in **RQ6**°.

Evaluation criteria

To evaluate to what extent the strategy meets the aforementioned requirements, the following evaluation criteria will be used.

Under the condition that the strategy integrates any type of context and is able to remove it, the criterium will be fulfilled.

The requirement of multiple sources will be evaluated by looking at how different sources are differentiated and how extensible the system is. How easy is it to add new sources?

To evaluate to which use-cases the strategy is applicable, limitations will be identified and discussed.

Lastly, the overhead will be measured by the amount of additional tokens generated and the number of generation steps.

Heritage

This section will discuss the origin of the strategy and insights which led to its evolution.

In general, the strategy is derived from planning meta-strategies and from Agrawal et al.[3].

These meta-strategies decompose a complex problem into multiple steps, where each step contributes to a previous step, solving the problem incrementally. A CLM will be prompted for each step, producing a partial or finished result.

Such meta-strategies include Chain-of-Thought[9], Tree of Thoughts[10], Graph of Thoughts[43] and others.

Typically, each prompt to the model contains the shared partial solution and instructions for the current step. The first observation is that the caveat of these strategies is the **granularity of control**. The external monitor processes and may edit partial results in any way, before continuing with the next step, passing a new prompt to the model, containing the partial result and instructions. Observing and editing the partial result only works on the granularity of a full generation cycle. The second observation is that the benefit of such a coarse granularity is the ease with which the prompt can be edited. As the edit happens outside of the model generation, large edits, affecting the whole prompt are possible.

The approach in Agrawal et al.[3] work controls the model generation on a token by token basic, through the use of a monitor. The monitor observes the generation and decides for each token, if control is necessary. If so, then the monitor will control the generation of the next few tokens, until it is not necessary anymore. The third observation is that the monitor has control only over sequences of tokens, but does not edit the prompt itself, to nudge the model towards a different response. The final observation is that the benefit of the strategy is the fine granularity on which the strategy operates. The monitor has access to the generation in realtime.

Combining the aforementioned observations, the interrupt-based meta-strategy combines the fine granularity needed to monitor the generation in realtime, with the prompt editing capabilities of multi-step meta-strategies.

Components

An overview over the strategy is given in Figure 4. All components in blue are additions to the normal model generation.

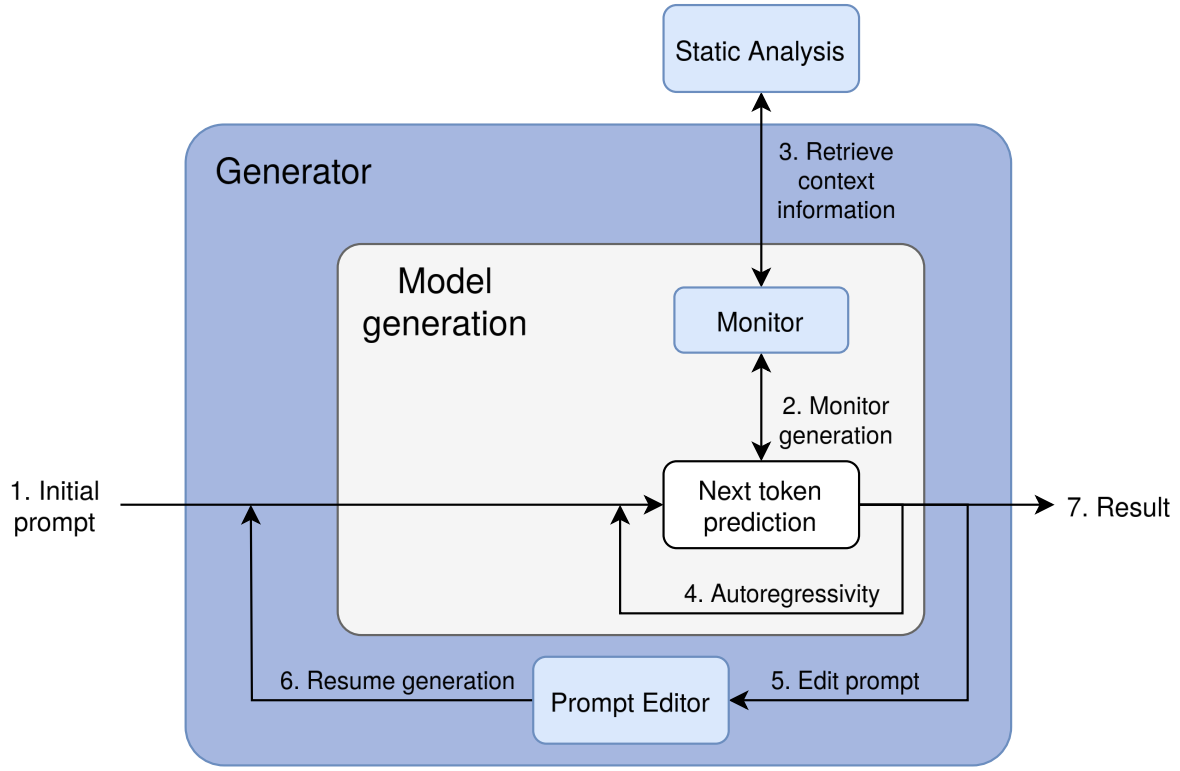


Figure 4: Components of the interrupt-based meta-strategy

In summary, the components Generator, PromptEditor, Monitor and Static Analysis allow context interruption through a custom interrupt special token, prompt edits and resumption through a controlled model generation loop.

The first main component is the Generator. It is the main component orchestrating or initializing the different components. To generate a response using the interrupt-based meta-strategy, first a Generator must be initialized. It in turn will initialize the Monitor, the Prompt Editor and a connection to external Static Analysis tooling.

In addition, it will initialize the tokenizer and model, adding a custom special token to the vocabulary of the tokenizer and resizing the model embeddings to fit the new special token. The new special token is called the interrupt token and enables interrupting the generation process, as the interrupt token will be added as a stopping criterium.

The Generator will start the model generation process, providing the initial prompt to the model. After the model finishes the whole generation, it will check the final token. If the final token is **not** an interrupt token, the generation process finished normally and the final result is available. Else the generation was interrupted with additional context.

Then the next component, the PromptEditor is called. It will read the retrieved context and edit the prompt in any way.

```
[INST]<SYS>
system prompt
</SYS>
user prompt
[/INST]
model output
```

Listing 30: Format of a typical model generation result

The PromptEditor is completely flexible in where it applies the edits. It may apply the edits to the system prompt or user prompt. It can even dynamically change the model output. The edited prompt is then passed into the model generation again, repeating the generation process.

Inside the model generation, the component Monitor watches the generation process, deciding if an interrupt is necessary. It was injected into the default model generation process, by the Generator. The Monitor is called for each token prediction, receiving the previous token sequence and the next token prediction and optionally modifying the prediction logits. In its functionality it is similar to the monitor in Agrawal et al.[3], but with the difference that it only controls the prediction of the special interrupt token. If an interrupt is necessary, the Monitor will force the prediction of the interrupt token, thus stopping the generation process. In addition, it will provide context for retrieval inside the Generator.

To decide if an interrupt is necessary, the Monitor will call an external Static Analysis tool. The Static Analysis component represents any form of external tooling that can analyze the current generation and provide additional context. This could include a web search of named entities, a keyword search in local documents or LSP tooling. If no additional context was found, the model generation proceeds normally.

To reduce the number of interruptions, the Monitor will only interrupt the generation if the additional context is not yet present in the prompt.

3.2 Language Server Protocol aided generation

The LSP aided generation builds upon the interrupt-based meta-strategy. It applies the strategy to neural code completion, injecting context information from the LSP server. In addition to injecting context into the prompt, the logits in the next token prediction are controlled using the context, to improve the robustness of the work.

This section will first talk about the heritage, introduce the components of the design and lastly discuss design decisions.

Heritage

The key thought guiding the work is:

> Developers base their decisions on contextual information provided by the LSP server.
> Why can't the neural code completion do the same?

Developers use a wide variety of tools to guide their programming decisions. Code completion is the most frequently used tool inside IDEs[1]. It displays available symbols, their documentation and type information. Next to code completion, signature help is another important tool, as it displays available parameters of selected functions and their types, thus providing information about the structure of the data. Additionally, IDEs highlight the code with diagnostics information, such as important errors or warnings which may be ignored. The diagnostics information guide the developer to potential problems, such wrong symbols, or code smells, such as dead code.

Components

An overview over the work is given in Figure 5. All components in blue are additions to the normal model generation.

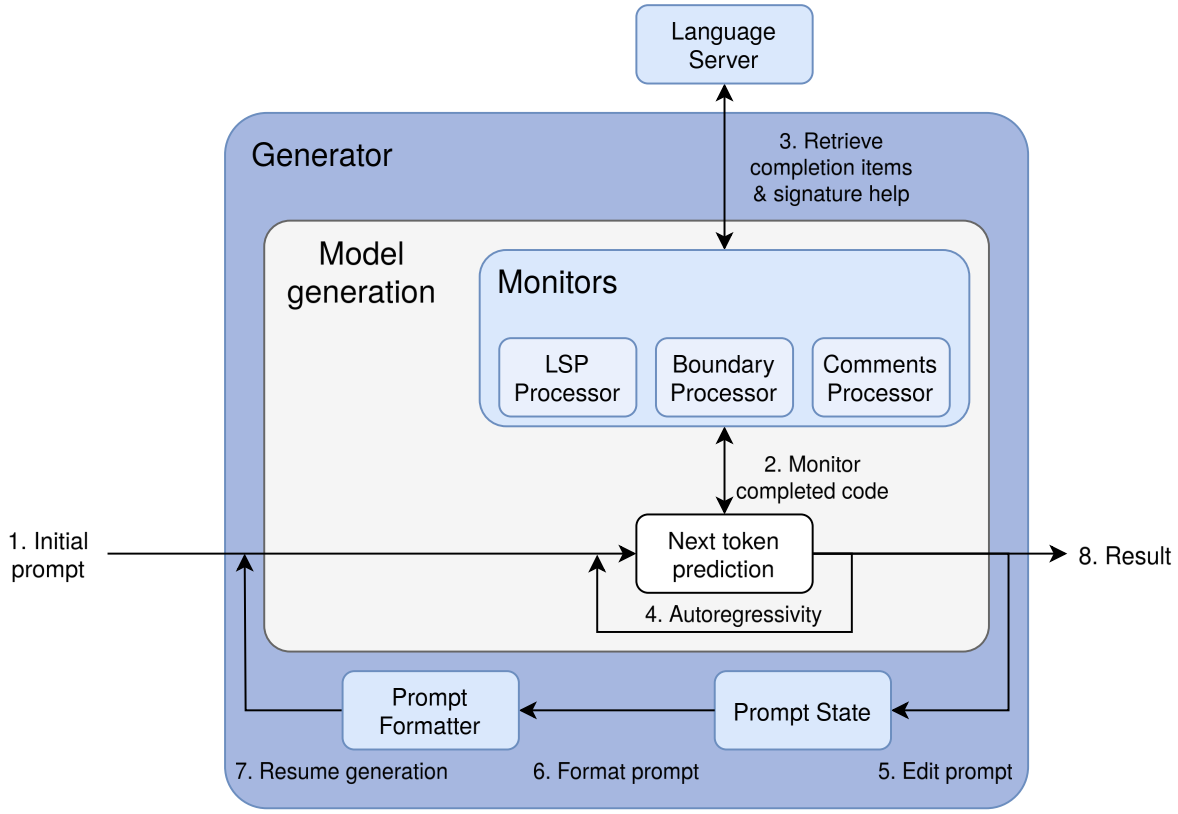


Figure 5: Components of the LSP aided generation

As the work is based on the interrupt-based meta-strategy, the components are similar to the ones in Figure 4. The main difference is the added complexity in the previous Monitor component, which now features several distinct subcomponents. Other differences are the specific use of LSP and a more complex prompt processing.

The Generator component depicted in Figure 5 is more specific in handling the prompt and injected context. The previous component Prompt Editor is now replaced with the two more specific components Prompt State and Prompt Formatter.

The Prompt State component contains a structured representation of the initial prompt and all injected context information. It is a general utility class, which is used in the Monitors and in the Generator to extract the completed code and to reconstruct the edited prompt. Extraction of the completed code is possible by detokenizing the partial result and removing the initial prompt prefix. As often the detokenization is not the inverse of the tokenization, the Prompt State class includes fixes for the detokenization. To reconstruct the edited prompt, the Prompt State passes the initial prompt and injected contexts to the Prompt Formatter.

The Prompt Formatter abstracts different prompt formats used in different models. For Llama based models, it would use the format defined in Listing 30. Different models allow different prompt sections, such as a system and a user prompt. Depending on the availability of such sections, the component decides how to embed the context.

The difference in the Monitors is the threefold divide into subcomponents. The first subcomponent LSP Processor corresponds to the previous component Monitor. It receives context from a Language Server (previous Static Analysis) and enables the interrupt-based meta-strategy applied to code completion. The task of the LSP Processor is twofold. First, it enables the interrupt-based meta-strategy. Secondly, it controls the logits to force the model towards certain behavior, when guiding is not enough.

The purpose of the Boundary Processor is to fix boundary issues when using tokenizers which allow multi-character tokens. Usually, LSP information, such as autocompletion and signature help, is requested after every keystroke in an IDE, or for certain hotkeys. The autocompletion information is especially useful after the dereference operator (. in Python, -> in C++), as then available symbols are displayed. The signature help information is useful after starting to write a function call, as then the available parameters are displayed.

As tokenizers allow tokens with several characters, the vocabulary could include tokens that start with a trigger character, followed by any tail. For autocompletion, this could include tokens such as .model. For signature help, this could be a token such as (). By predicting these tokens, the completed code would "jump" over the critical trigger characters, thus ignoring the autocompletion or signature help information.

The Boundary Processor fixes this issue by identifying all tokens prefixed with a trigger character and replacing these tokens with the trigger character only. It ensures that the logits value of the trigger character is higher than any other token containing the trigger character as a prefix.

Next to the Boundary Processor, the Comments Processor solves an issue regarding the generation of comments. A possible place to inject the context is in the completed code, as a code comment. The problem is that a model could see the code comments after an interrupt and try to predict a code comment preceding the next code block. Thus, code comments could be tainted by the code prediction itself The Comments Processor disallows the generation of code comments, by stopping the prediction of the token starting a code comment by setting the logits value to $-\infty$.

Design Decisions

This section provides details on different design decision for the introduced components.

The first design decision is the selection of sources to suggest fitting code, as introduced in **RQ1**°. The previous sections already highlight why the LSP is fitting. The protocol provides a vast amount of different information. We argue that the core information to use are the completion items and the signature help information.

When generating code, the primary source are the completion items, as they dictate the available symbols. The completion items list the attributes of objects and which attributes are deprecated and should be replaced.

After using the completion items to write callable code, the secondary source is the signature help. Likewise, the signature help lists available parameters of a function call and includes documentation.

Both types of information sources allow code generation using up-to-date information. Other features provided through LSP may improve code generation, but are not vital, such as diagnostics information. In addition, both sources can be used on partial code and provide suggestions on how to extend the code, aiding the natural CLM generation flow. Diagnostic information and other information reference code already written, increasing the difficulty to integrate into the natural generation flow.

The second design decision, **RQ2**°, is about processing the completion items and signature help information. Both sources provide critical information, but also a lot of unrelevant information not needed to decide on the next code piece. Such context pollutes the context window of CLM and worsens the prediction quality. As such, preprocessing is needed to filter such data.

Completion items are initially filtered by their CompletionItemKind[3]. Only items of kind Method, Field, Class, Function, Property or Variable are allowed, to remove kinds such as Snippet, Color and File.

To reduce confusion further, completion items of builtins are removed, as the assumption is made that the model has the knowledge of builtins. If the model does not have knowledge about builtins, this filter can be disabled, to e.g improve support of low resource languages. Filtering is done by checking the detail field of the completion item, as it contains the origin of the code item, such as the code file.

Next, completion items from the current code piece are removed. Similarily, it is assumed that the current code is in the context of the CLM. Again, this filter checks the detail field of the completion item.

Then private or meta functions are removed, such as the __getitem__ function in Python. These functions are not meant to be called directly.

To avoid the completion of already completed code, the to be inserted text is checked against the ending of the currently generated code. This also removes items which do not properly extend the current code.

Then the completion items are split into two categories, the non-deprecated and the deprecated completion items. This differentiation allows later steps to guide the model towards non-deprecated items, while avoiding deprecated items.

The model may be biased towards generating old deprecated code. To only focus on the deprecated items, which the model **may** predict, the deprecated items are finally filtered by the next predicted token.

3.3 Dataset design

Finally, the dataset design is critical for the evaluation of the method.

The most important attributes of the dataset are a pinned environment with known dependencies, a gold standard solution and unit tests which test for functional and approach correctness.

Each entry in the dataset shall have the following format:

[3]The full list is visible in Listing 32

```json
{
  "task_id": "PackageEval_{int}",
  "task_name": "{string}_{int}",
  "test_code": "{string}",
  "import_statements": ["{string}"],
  "package_dependencies": ["{string}"],
  "context": "{string}",
  "function_signature": "{string}",
  "function_documentation": "{string}",
  "entry_point": "{string}",
  "solution": "{string}",
  "reason": "{string}",
  "kind": "{kind}",
  "date": "%Y-%m-%d",
  "code_kind": "{code_kind}",
  "modification_kind": "{modification_kind}",
  "changelog": "{url}"
}
```

Listing 31: Dataset format

4 Implementation

4.1 Interrupt-based meta-strategy

4.2 Language Server Protocol aided generation

4.3 Dataset design

5 Results

5.1 Collection method

5.2 Possible configurations

5.3 Results

6 Evaluation

6.1 Research Questions

6.2 Evaluation difficulties

6.3 Evaluation

7 Conclusion

7.1 Recap

7.2 Outlook

Acronyms

BOS: Begin of Sequence

BPE: Byte Pair Encoding

CLM: Causal Language Models

Code LLM: Large Language Model for Code

EOS: End of Sequence

IDE: Integrated Development Environment

JSON: JavaScript Object Notation

JSON-RPC: JavaScript Object Notation-Remote Procedure Call

LLM: Large Language Models

LM: Language Model

LSP: Language Server Protocol

MIME: Multipurpose Internet Mail Extensions

PAD: Padding

RAG: Retrieval Augmented Generation

RPC: Remote Procedure Call

URI: Uniform Resource Identifier

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Appendix

Language	Language ID
ABAP	abap
Windows Bat	bat
BibTeX	bibtex
Clojure	clojure
Coffeescript	coffeescript
C	c
C++	cpp
C#	csharp
CSS	css
Diff	diff
Dart	dart
Dockerfile	dockerfile
Elixir	elixir
Erland	erlang
F#	fsharp
Git	git-commit and git-rebase
Go	go
Groovy	groovy
Handlebars	handlebars
HTML	html
Ini	ini
Java	java
JavaScript	javascript
JavaScript React	javascriptreact
JSON	json
LaTeX	latex
Less	less
Lua	lua
Makefile	makefile
Markdown	markdown
Objective-C	objective-c
Objective-C++	objective-cpp
Perl	perl
Perl 6	perl6
PHP	php
Powershell	powershell
Pug	jade
Python	python
R	r
Razor	razor
Ruby	ruby
Rust	rust
SCSS	scss or sass
Scala	scala
ShaderLab	shaderlab
Shellscript	shellscript
SQL	sql
Swift	swift
TypeScript	typescript
TypeScript React	typescriptreact
TeX	tex
Visual Basic	vb
XML	xml
XSL	xsl
YAML	yaml

Table 6: Possible language ids defined in the LSP specification

```typescript
namespace CompletionItemKind {
    const Text: 1;
    const Method: 2;
    const Function: 3;
    const Constructor: 4;
    const Field: 5;
    const Variable: 6;
    const Class: 7;
    const Interface: 8;
    const Module: 9;
    const Property: 10;
    const Unit: 11;
    const Value: 12;
    const Enum: 13;
    const Keyword: 14;
    const Snippet: 15;
    const Color: 16;
    const File: 17;
    const Reference: 18;
    const Folder: 19;
    const EnumMember: 20;
    const Constant: 21;
    const Struct: 22;
    const Event: 23;
    const Operator: 24;
    const TypeParameter: 25;
}
type CompletionItemKind = 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10 | 11 | 12 | 13 | 14 | 15 | 16 | 17 | 18 | 19 | 20 | 21 | 22 | 23 | 24 | 25;
```

Listing 32: CompletionItemKind enum

QR code



Scan the QR code to access the source code of this thesis:
https://github.com/data-niklas/master_thesis°